

Social Media Policy 12

SOCIAL MEDIA POLICY

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Policy Number: COM-002
Policy Title: Social Media Policy
Effective Date: January 1, 2026
Review Date: January 1, 2027
Owner: Communications Department

PURPOSE

This policy establishes guidelines for employee use of social media to protect GlobalTech Corporation's reputation, ensure compliance with laws and regulations, and provide clear guidance on appropriate social media conduct.

SCOPE

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, and representatives of GlobalTech Corporation, including personal social media use that references the company.

GENERAL PRINCIPLES

Professional Conduct

- Maintain professional standards in all social media activity
- Represent the company positively when identifying as an employee
- Exercise good judgment and common sense
- Remember that social media is public and permanent

Transparency

- Disclose your affiliation with GlobalTech when posting about company-related topics
- Use appropriate disclaimers for personal opinions
- Clearly distinguish personal views from company positions
- Be honest and authentic in your communications

Respect

- Treat others with respect and civility
- Avoid offensive, discriminatory, or harassing content
- Respect privacy and confidentiality
- Do not engage in online arguments or conflicts

PERSONAL SOCIAL MEDIA USE

General Guidelines

- Personal social media use during work hours should be minimal
- Do not let social media interfere with work responsibilities
- Maintain appropriate privacy settings on personal accounts
- Be aware that even private posts can become public

Company References

- You may identify yourself as a GlobalTech employee
- Make clear that your views are your own, not the company's
- Do not present yourself as an official company spokesperson
- Use appropriate disclaimers: "Views are my own"

Confidential Information

- Never share confidential or proprietary information
- Do not discuss internal company matters publicly
- Protect trade secrets and sensitive data
- Follow data security and privacy policies

Company Content

- Do not share internal communications, documents, or presentations
- Respect copyright and intellectual property rights
- Do not post photos of company facilities without permission
- Obtain approval before sharing company-created content

OFFICIAL COMPANY SOCIAL MEDIA

Authorized Accounts

- Only authorized personnel may post on official company accounts
- Social media team manages all official company accounts
- Employee advocacy programs have specific guidelines
- Contact Communications for official account access

Content Guidelines

- Align with company brand voice and values
- Ensure accuracy of all information shared
- Obtain appropriate approvals for content
- Follow editorial and approval processes

Crisis Communications

- Only designated spokespersons address crises on social media
- Report potential social media crises to Communications immediately
- Do not respond to negative comments on official accounts
- Follow established crisis communication procedures

BUSINESS-RELATED SOCIAL MEDIA

Professional Networking

- LinkedIn and similar platforms encouraged for professional networking
- Maintain accurate and up-to-date professional profiles
- Connect with colleagues and industry professionals appropriately
- Use professional headshots and appropriate content

Industry Discussions

- Participate in industry discussions professionally
- Share expertise and insights when appropriate
- Respect differing opinions and perspectives
- Do not disclose confidential company information

Thought Leadership

- Employees encouraged to share industry expertise
- Obtain approval before publishing company-related articles
- Use appropriate disclaimers for personal content
- Coordinate with Communications for major thought leadership pieces

PROHIBITED ACTIVITIES

Content Restrictions

- Do not post content that is discriminatory, harassing, or offensive
- Do not engage in hate speech or promote violence
- Do not share false or misleading information
- Do not post content that could damage the company's reputation

Confidentiality Violations

- Never share confidential business information
- Do not discuss financial results before public release
- Protect customer and partner information
- Do not share internal strategies or plans

Legal Compliance

- Comply with all applicable laws and regulations
- Respect intellectual property rights
- Follow advertising and disclosure requirements
- Comply with industry-specific regulations

Competitor References

- Do not make false or misleading statements about competitors
- Avoid disparaging competitors publicly
- Do not use confidential competitor information
- Follow fair competition guidelines

ENDORSEMENTS AND TESTIMONIALS

Product Endorsements

- Do not endorse company products without authorization
- Disclose any material connections when endorsing products
- Follow FTC disclosure guidelines for endorsements
- Obtain approval for any company-related endorsements

Customer References

- Do not share customer information without permission
- Obtain written consent for customer testimonials
- Respect customer privacy and confidentiality
- Follow customer reference policies

Media Inquiries

- Direct all media inquiries to Communications
- Do not respond to journalist inquiries on social media
- Do not provide official statements to media
- Contact Communications for media guidance

MONITORING AND ENFORCEMENT

Monitoring

- Company may monitor official social media accounts
- Employees' personal social media not routinely monitored
- Company responds to credible reports of policy violations
- Social media scanning for brand reputation management

Enforcement

- Policy violations may result in disciplinary action
- Serious violations may result in termination
- Legal action may be taken for violations causing harm
- Employees may be liable for damages caused by violations

Reporting

- Report policy violations to manager or HR
- Report social media crises to Communications immediately
- Anonymous reporting available through ethics hotline
- Security responds to immediate threats

TRAINING AND RESOURCES

Social Media Training

- Social media training available for all employees
- Specialized training for social media team members
- Regular updates on policy changes and best practices
- Resources available on company intranet

Best Practices

- Think before you post
- Consider your audience and potential reach
- Remember that posts are permanent and searchable
- When in doubt, don't post

Resources

- Communications Department: communications@globaltech.com
- HR Department: hr@globaltech.com
- Legal Department: legal@globaltech.com
- Social Media Guidelines on company intranet

CONTACT INFORMATION

Communications Department

Phone: 555-0188

Email: communications@globaltech.com

Location: 5th Floor, Communications Department

For questions about this policy, contact the Communications Department.

POLICY ACKNOWLEDGMENT

I acknowledge that I have read and understand the Social Media Policy. I agree to comply with all provisions and understand that violations may result in disciplinary action.

Employee Signature: _____

Employee Name: _____

Employee ID: _____

Date: _____